Recurse Center

The place for curious programmers.

Spend 6 or 12 weeks programming at the edge of your abilities with a community of kind, motivated peers. Do a programming retreat in NYC or remotely.

Work hard on *your* projects.

Remind yourself why programming rocks with code that sparks your joy and curiosity. You pick the projects you work on, with no deadlines, grades, or OKRs.

Gain the support and insight of 2,900+ people. Go further together.

You'll get to work with and learn from kind and curious programmers of all skill levels. Whether you're an EM ready to code again, a self-taught hobbyist, a staff engineer, a recent grad, or a former founder, there's a place for you at RC.

Get connected to great companies.

Our optional recruiting services keep RC 100% free for everyone. If you want a new job, we can connect you with new opportunities.

Learn more

“The Recurse Center gave me time, space, light and clarity I never knew was possible. Being here has been transformational as a programmer and a human being. I'm in awe that this place exists and it's ours.

– Helen Ngo, ML Engineer and Researcher

“Attending the Recurse Center has been life-changing for me. Never before in my life have I had this experience of being surrounded by kind people, supporting each other and cooperating, focused on improvement and learning, avoiding competition. The lack of curriculum really hits!

– Jonathan Strickland, Senior Backend Engineer

“The Recurse Center is one of those rare things where you find a small group of dedicated people who believe in a cause and pour their heart and soul into it, and it shows. I would recommend this to anybody who wants to invest time in becoming a dramatically better programmer.

– Andrew Kelley, creator of Zig

> RC is a magical place where you go to become a better programmer. The diversity and a super welcoming environment have made RC one of the best educational experiences I've ever had!
>
> – *Serena Peruzzo, Senior Data Scientist*

Gain focus and accountability

With all the resources and distractions of the internet, it can be hard to know what to work on first—or even work up the motivation to start.

RC gives you a clear beginning, end, purpose, and name for your time off—and friendly social accountability to keep you going. With our supportive facilitators, you'll get better at directing your time, picking your projects, and meeting the goals you set for yourself.

You'll have 24/7 access to our Brooklyn hub—perfect for quiet work or on-demand serendipity.

During your retreat, you'll learn how to optimize your time and abilities—and do more than you thought was possible.

Plan your retreat

Discover what's next

RC is an ideal way to spend time between jobs: it gives you time and space to clear your head, grow as a programmer, and think intentionally about what you want out of your next job and beyond.

At RC, you'll receive lifelong career support with a team of recruiters who know and care about you. Our Career Services team provides personalized job recommendations and referrals for companies that align with your values and goals (from a human, not an algorithm). Plus, you'll be matched with friendly alumni mock interviewers who have been in your shoes and gone on to work at successful companies.

Invest in your career

Find your people

It's hard to focus on programming when you don't feel like you belong.

For over a decade, we've worked to build an environment that is not just productive and educational, but also supportive, friendly, and positive. We provided over $1.7 million in living expense grants for underrepresented groups in tech and lightweight social rules to foster collaborative growth.

Come to RC and learn generously – no matter your background.

Learn about our approach